

# Cybernetic Oracle

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### ACM Reference Format:

Hannen Wolfe. 2024. Cybernetic Oracle. In *Proceedings of SIGGRAPH Art Gallery '24*. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 1 page. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3641523.3665169>

## 1 DESCRIPTION OF ARTWORK

Do Large Language Models produce the truth or technological hallucinations? Cybernetic Oracle invites visitors to use cartomancy to gain insight into their past, present and future with a custom deck of 78 tarot cards and a book of tarot interpretations designed by the artist in collaboration with generative AI models.

Conversations around the accuracy of Large Language Models (LLMs) focus on the issue of AI hallucinations and how to mitigate their occurrences. This belief is dependent on the assumption that these models have an accurate understanding of reality, when in fact they are always hallucinating. It is simply that their hallucinations often align with reality. The information generated by LLMs is sometimes misleading and often incomplete, lacking proper citations or sources, so the answer cannot be verified. They are more likely to perpetuate biases and archetypes that exist in the datasets that they are trained on. The results generated by these models can be subject to biases in the dataset, including demographic, cultural and linguistic biases. LLMs are a radicalization risk for users because their answers are prone to confirmation bias. Believable, factually ambiguous AI generated text and imagery is becoming more common online and without proper regulation can be indistinguishable from human generated content. The artwork, *Cybernetic Oracle*, emphasizes the immediate need for not only media literacy but also AI literacy, the ability to critically analyze text generated by an artificially intelligent model to determine its credibility and accuracy. It questions the belief that AI generates truth instead of purely technological hallucinations.

Visitors can interact with the artwork, Cybernetic Oracle, by shuffling the tarot deck and drawing three cards to represent their past, present and future. They can then look up the meaning of each card in the accompanying book. The tarot cards were designed by the artist in collaboration with a deep learning, text-to-image model and an LLM. The artist collaborated with the LLM to create a list of card names for the major arcana and suits of a cybernetic tarot deck. The artist created the image for each tarot card by manipulating and merging two images generated by the text-to-image model.

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*SIGGRAPH Art Gallery '24, July 27 - August 01, 2024, Denver, CO, USA*

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ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-0529-8/24/07

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3641523.3665169>



To create the images the LLM generated a 40-word description for the traditional tarot card and a 40-word description for the cybernetic tarot card, each of which were used as a prompt for the text-to-image model. Using image manipulation software, the artist combined the two images and stylized them to create a consistent aesthetic and card form. The book includes interpretations for each card, in relation to the tarot reader's past, present and future. The text for the book was created by querying an LLM fine-tuned on the writings of cyberneticists, cyberfeminists, ecofeminists and technopagans.

Cybernetic Oracle uses the symbolic nature of tarot cards to emphasize generative AI's predisposition for archetypal representation. It questions Large Language Models' understanding and interpretation of reality drawing parallels between divination and querying a model for information.

## 2 PROJECT URL

<http://projectiveplanes.com/>